

Recent articles about environmental impact of AI (the new Satan)

Posted by u/AlfaTurbulent7728 • 0 points • 14 comments

Im doing a paper about this and Im surprised all I can generally find are just articles saying AI is destroying the environment faster than Chinese factories.

Then I stumbled upon this sub and Im surprised to learn that no, AI isnt the new Satan.

So which one is it? Mainstream media is never a trustworthy source but Im already brainwashed thinking “naaah its gotta be true that AI is using too much water and all that”.

Comments

u/elleinfinity • 1 points • 2025-11-10 21:02 UTC

Anti social terminally online types much prefer infinite porn generator over the annoying reminder that the same technology is going to destroy the habitability of the planet.

Computer make happy. Danger big scary
Nihilism nihilism hedonism ignorance

✨ bliss ✨

u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-11-10 17:42 UTC

Here are a few on energy:

u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-11-10 17:42 UTC

[<https://electricityplans.com/how-much-electricity-does-a-coffee-maker-use/>]

(<https://electricityplans.com/how-much-electricity-does-a-coffee-maker-use/>)

[<https://www.theverge.com/24066646/ai-electricity-energy-watts-generative-consumption>]

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[<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>]

(<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>)

[https://www.linkedin.com/posts/robertdavidclay_gpt-4-prompt-energy-vs-keurig-coffee-brew-activity-7333180258503839745-TtVa]

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[<https://medium.com/data-science/the-carbon-footprint-of-gpt-4-d6c676eb21ae>]

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[<https://engineeringprompts.substack.com/p/ai-energy-use>]
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[<https://adam.holter.com/why-your-chatgpt-prompt-uses-half-the-energy-of-a-tiktok-video/>]
(<https://adam.holter.com/why-your-chatgpt-prompt-uses-half-the-energy-of-a-tiktok-video/>)
[<https://e360.yale.edu/features/artificial-intelligence-climate-energy-emissions>]
(<https://e360.yale.edu/features/artificial-intelligence-climate-energy-emissions>)
[https://www.linkedin.com/posts/damianthorkelson_gpt-4-prompt-energy-vs-keurig-coffee-brew-activity-7333442610457399296-H_yA](https://www.linkedin.com/posts/damianthorkelson_gpt-4-prompt-energy-vs-keurig-coffee-brew-activity-7333442610457399296-H_yA)

u/Pretend_Jacket1629 • 3 points • 2025-11-10 02:02 UTC

fearmongers either maliciously or ignorantly fail to grasp the sheer miniscule scale of energy used by ai nearly everything in your house uses on the scale of tens to hundreds of times the energy equivalent to a typical local image generated- and that's just phantom draw from being plugged in.

xboxes alone could possibly use more energy than every image ever generated by mankind within the span of 1 week.... of not even being turned on

u/MysteriousPepper8908 • 5 points • 2025-11-10 01:29 UTC

The trick is the figures for AI's water use and environmental impact do look very scary until you actually look at how the numbers compare to other industries. It's very easy to make numbers that look scary if you don't understand the actual orders of magnitude.

u/Mikhael_Love • 3 points • 2025-11-10 00:15 UTC

Links

u/SXC-150 • 2 points • 2025-11-10 12:26 UTC

This is a lot of information!
Thank you!

u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-11-10 00:17 UTC

[<https://www.vertiv.com/en-us/solutions/learn-about/liquid-cooling-options-for-data-centers/>]
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u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-11-10 00:17 UTC

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<https://www.npr.org/2022/08/30/1119938708/data-centers-backbone-of-the-digital-economy-face-water-scarcity-and-climate-ris>

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u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-11-10 00:15 UTC

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u/Nocebola • 9 points • 2025-11-09 23:11 UTC

https://www.waterfootprint.org/resources/Mekonnen-Hoekstra-2012-WaterFootprintFarmAnimalProducts_1.pdf

the Gerbens-Leenes, Mekonnen & Hoekstra study in 2013 found that one pound of beef used over 15,415 L/4000 Gal of water to produce.

Chat GPT used 125 prompts per gallon of water.

So when you eat a pound of beef it's equivalent to using chat GPT 500,000 times.

Call it whatabutism all you want but this shit is like blaming plastic straws for plastic in the ocean.

Americans eat about 59 pounds of beef annually.

That's almost 30 million chat gpt prompts per year per person worth of water.

That's also not including the carbon footprint of distribution of that meat.

u/KallyWally • 9 points • 2025-11-09 21:59 UTC

Andy Masley has [many well-researched articles](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/ai-and-the-environment>) on the subject.

u/Nocebola • 1 points • 2025-11-09 23:10 UTC

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u/AlfaTurbulent7728 • 7 points • 2025-11-09 22:04 UTC

Thank you!! This what I need